COURSE GUIDE & SYLLABUS · GRADES 3–6 · AGES 8–11

Financial Literacy (Gr 3–5) Beginner: Money Smart · Level 1

Count rupees, make change, plan a budget, save for a goal, shop smart, stay safe with UPI, and run your own mini market stall.

A hands-on first money course for children aged 8 to 11, set in everyday Indian life: the kirana shop, pocket money, school trips, birthdays, Diwali shopping and UPI payments. Module 1 covers the basics: where money came from (barter to coins, notes and digital money), counting rupees and making change like a shopkeeper, needs and wants and what every choice really costs, and making a weekly budget with Spend, Save and Share jars, ending with a project to plan a birthday party on ₹2,000. Module 2 makes children smart with money: setting a savings goal and tracking it on a chart, comparing prices and unit prices, seeing through offers and ads, checking bills and change, understanding UPI, QR codes and cards, and the safety rules (never share a PIN or OTP, always ask a grown-up, spot fake prizes). The capstone is a class market where every child plans a pretend stall, works out cost, price and profit, makes a poster and pitch, and sells with play money. Every lesson has a short narrated video, a play-money follow-along, budget simulations with a live balance bar, sorting, matching and ordering games, a new-situation challenge, a printable activity sheet and a teacher script.

What learners will be able to do

- Explain how money replaced barter, and name Indian coins and notes
- Count rupees from the biggest note down and make change by counting up
- Sort needs from wants and explain what a choice costs (what you give up)
- Make a weekly budget that adds up, using Spend, Save and Share jars
- Plan a ₹2,000 party: must-haves first, savings kept, nice-to-haves that fit
- Set a savings goal with a price and a date, work out the weeks and track it
- Compare prices and simple unit prices, judge offers and spot ad tricks
- Check a bill and count change before leaving a shop
- Explain simply what UPI, QR codes and cards do, and follow the money safety rules
- Spot scam messages and always tell a grown-up
- Work out cost, price and profit, and run a pretend market stall with play money

How every lesson works

Watch	A short animated explainer video with captions and read-aloud narration.
Learn	Short Learn cards with real-life Indian examples.
Practise	Games and interactive tasks: speaking practice with a checklist, budget simulations, sorting and matching, with instant feedback.
Probe	Use the skill in a new everyday situation and explain your thinking.

Projects	Something real every module: a talk, a plan, a poster, a budget. Reviewed with a rubric.
Printables	Worksheet for every lesson, project brief for every project and a teacher lesson plan with answer keys.

Scope and sequence

#	Lesson	Big idea	Learners build
1	**What Is Money?** Explain how people moved from swapping to coins, notes and digital money, count Indian rupees quickly and make correct change at a shop counter.	Money and change	Set up your shop counter
2	**Needs and Wants** Sort needs from wants, see that the same thing can be either, and explain what you give up when you choose, while planning a ₹500 school trip.	Choices have costs	My needs and wants T-chart
3	**Making a Budget** Make a simple weekly budget with income, spending and saving, and split pocket money into Spend, Save and Share jars.	Budget and 3 jars	Make your three jars
4	**Project: Plan a Birthday Party on ₹2,000** Plan a birthday party on ₹2,000 that covers the must-haves, picks nice-to-haves that fit, keeps ₹200 as savings, and present it like a party planner.	Planning a budget	Project: My ₹2,000 birthday party plan
5	**Saving for a Goal** Set a savings goal with a price and a date, work out how many weeks it will take, and track it on a chart.	Goals and patience	Make your savings goal chart
6	**Smart Shopping** Compare prices and unit prices, see through offers and ads, and check the bill and change, while doing the family's Diwali shopping on ₹1,000.	Compare and check	Price detective at home
7	**Digital Money and Staying Safe** Explain simply how UPI, QR codes and cards move money, and follow the safety rules: never share a PIN or OTP, always ask a grown-up, and spot scams.	Digital money safety	Be a scam detective
8	**Capstone: My Mini Market Stall** Plan and run a pretend market stall: choose a product, work out cost, price and profit, make a poster and a sales pitch, and sell with play money.	Cost, price, profit	Project: My mini market stall

Modules

Module 1 · Money basics
Where money came from, counting rupees and making change, needs and wants, and a weekly budget with three jars. Project: plan a birthday party on ₹2,000.

Big question: How do I count, choose and plan, so my money goes where I really want it to?

Module 2 · Smart with money
Saving for a goal, smart shopping (unit price, offers, ads, bills), digital money and safety, and a capstone mini market stall with cost, price and profit.

Big question: How can I save, shop, stay safe and even earn, like a smart grown-up?

Assessment

Coding challenges are checked on the server by running the learner's program. Quick checks give instant feedback. Written answers and projects are reviewed by the teacher against 4-level rubrics (Beginning · Developing · Secure · Excellent).

What you need

- A device with a browser for the lesson video and activities
- Printed play money (sheet in lessons 1 and 8) or paper slips with values written on them
- Three jars, cups or envelopes for Spend, Save and Share (lesson 3)
- Paper, pencil, colours and squared paper for charts and posters
- A few packets from the kitchen for price detective (lesson 6, optional)
- The downloadable activity sheet for each lesson

Before you start

- Can add and subtract numbers up to 1,000 (with play money for support).
- No device skills needed beyond tapping and typing numbers.

Safety and privacy

Play money and pretend shops only: children never make real payments, and never see, type or share a real PIN, OTP, password or card number. Lesson 7 teaches that banks never ask for a PIN or OTP, that you never need a PIN to receive money, and that any online payment is done by a grown-up. No real investments, betting, lotteries, gaming purchases or crypto are discussed. Teachers never ask about family income or pocket money amounts; if a child shares a worrying real story (such as money lost to a scam), listen kindly and inform their grown-up after class.

What comes next

After this course: **Money Smart · Level 2 (banks, interest and a mini business)**.

Kitabash original curriculum.